



2026

GUIDELINE



POST-DOCTORAL FELLOWSHIP PROGRAM

**Advanced Studies & Research Board
UNIVERSITY OF KARACHI**



POST-DOCTORAL FELLOWSHIP PROGRAM

GUIDELINE

ADVANCED STUDIES & RESEARCH BOARD

Message



Prof. Dr. Khalid M. Iraqi
Vice Chancellor

Welcome to the University of Karachi, Postdoctoral Fellowship Program

Welcome to the next great step in your academic journey. It is with great zeal, that I welcome you to the University of Karachi, Postdoctoral Fellowship Program. We believe that the most transformative findings happen when cognitions are given the freedom to flourish. This is the core values in our Postdoctoral Fellowship Program.

Our postdoctoral fellows represent a dynamic part of our academic environment. They are not only early-career researchers; they are the architects of future's findings, the mentors for our next generation of students, and the facilitators for the interdisciplinary collaboration. University is not just a collection of buildings and laboratories; it is a community of thinkers, and achievers. As a postdoctoral fellow, you are a crucial part of this community. Your new ideas will revitalise our research culture.

It is a promise to your professional growth, to develop your independent research identity, and a chance to contribute expressively to our energetic knowledgeable community. We have curated an environment that encourages bold ideas, provides access to cutting-edge facilities, and fosters mentorship from leading scholars in their fields.

To our new and prospective fellows: we invite you to challenge conventions, push the borders of your disciplines, and work together in the departments. Look forward to seeing the contributions you will make and the lasting impression you will have on our community and beyond.

I encourage you to make the most of every moment here. Collaborate with colleagues you've just met, and embrace the challenges that lead to the most profound growth. Your success is our success.

Welcome to the community. Let's determine what's next, together.

Message



Prof. Dr. Anila Amber Malik
Director
Postgraduate Admission Committee

Welcome to the University of Karachi, Postdoctoral Fellowship Program

Postdoctoral Fellowship Program, goal is to ensure that your time here is not only productive but transformative. A postdoctoral engagement is an exclusive time in your career. It is a time to deepen your expertise, it is an opportunity to develop from the shadow of your doctoral work and create your own, liberated research identity.

I view our program with a definite perspective: preparing you for a successful and fulfilling career. Your research is the heart of your fellowship, the program itself is designed to provide the frame for your long-term professional development. I have the pleasure of observing able scholars from around the country come together to form a lively and collaborative community.

Postdoctoral Fellowship Program is constructed on a basis of exceptional mentorship and intentional professional development. We have gathered a network of eminent faculty mentors who are dedicated to your achievement, not just as researchers in their labs, but as future investigators, leaders, and policy advice-givers.

I encourage you to engage with the professional development networking events, and interdisciplinary forums in the University. These resources are intended to help you build the skills from grant writing to lab management that will define your academics.

Please consider my office and staff as your partners in this journey. I am pleased to observe the ideas you will bring to our campus.

ADVANCED STUDIES & RESEARCH BOARD UNIVERSITY OF KARACHI

Members of the Advanced Studies and Research Board

Chairman

Prof. Dr. Khalid M. Iraqi

Vice-Chancellor

Prof. Dr. Anila Amber Malik *Director, Postgraduate Admission Committee*

MEMBERS:

Deans of the Faculties

Prof. Dr. Samina Saeed	Dean, Faculty of Arts & Social Sciences
Prof. Dr. Zaeema Asrar Mohiuddin	Dean, Faculty of Management & Administrative Sciences
Prof. Dr. Harris Shoaib	Dean, Faculty of Pharmacy & Pharmaceutical Sciences
Prof. Dr. Zahid Ali Zahidi	Dean (Look-after), Faculty of Islamic Studies
Prof. Dr. Samina Saeed	Dean, (Look-after) Faculty of Education
Prof. Dr. Farida Islam	Dean, Faculty of Medicine
Prof. Dr. Bilqees Gul	Dean, Faculty of Science & Faculty of Engineering
Barrister Zeeshan Adhi	Dean, Faculty of Law

Nominees of the Syndicate

Prof. Dr. Anila Amber Malik	Department of Psychology
Prof. Dr. Syed Shabib-ul-Hasan	Department of Public Administration
Prof. Dr. Asma Manzoor	Centre of Excellence for Women's Studies

Nominees of the Academic Council

Prof. Dr. Basit Ansari	Department of Health, Physical Education & Sports Sciences
Prof. Dr. Uzma Ashiq	Department of Chemistry
Prof. Dr. Taseer Ahmed Khan	Department of Physiology

Professors Emeritus

Prof. Dr. Atta-ur-Rahman, FRS	International Centre for Chemical & Biological Sciences (ICCBS)
Prof. Dr. Muhammad Qaiser	Former Professor, Department of Botany
Prof. Dr. Zafar Saeed Saify	Former Professor of Pharmaceutical Chemistry

Registrar

Prof. Dr. Imran A. Siddiqui	Registrar
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INTRODUCTION

University of Karachi established in 1951, is one of the oldest institutions of higher education of Pakistan. It offers rigorous and vibrant graduate and post-graduate degree programs in the Faculties i.e. Arts & Social Sciences, Education, Engineering, Islamic Studies, Law, Management & Administrative Sciences, Medicine, Pharmacy & Pharmaceutical Sciences, and Science. The research and the teaching programs are supervised by about 400 qualified faculty members. These postgraduate programs are offered in 56 teaching departments and 21 research institutes and centers.

University of Karachi offers its graduate and post-graduate students well equipped laboratories, digital library and video-conferencing facilities in a multi-disciplinary environment. It is committed to uphold its tradition of producing top-quality graduates in cutting-edge areas of Business and Management Sciences, Bio-Medical & Engineering Sciences, Technologies, Social and Natural Sciences. The programs are designed to match the emerging needs of industries and research and development organizations, both in the public and private sectors.

During the last five years, University of Karachi has awarded more than 2000 MS (Surgery), MD (Medicine), MPhil, ME, LL.M and PhD degrees. Presently, approximately 5000 students are enrolled in MS (Surgery), MD (Medicine), MPhil, ME, LL.M. and Ph.D, programs. Faculty members at the University of Karachi are engaged in pursuing research in various disciplines and publish extensively in journals of international repute.

University of Karachi has established an internal Post-Doctoral Fellowship policy for scholars in several departments / centres / institute. The University of Karachi's Advanced Studies and Research Board and Academic Council has officially approved Post-Doctoral Fellowship policy. This is designed to engage fellows in research, teaching and other academic activities across different departments / centres / institutes. It is best to contact the Postgraduate Office for further details.

University of Karachi provides excellent opportunities to its Post-Doctoral scholars for linkages, trainings and collaboration with the world's top universities in research projects in the technologically advanced countries.

FACULTIES

- 1. Faculty of Arts & Social Sciences**
- 2. Faculty of Islamic Studies**
- 3. Faculty of Management &
Administrative Sciences**
- 4. Faculty of Pharmacy & Pharmaceutical
Sciences**
- 5. Faculty of Science**

DEPARTMENTS / INSTITUTES / CENTRES

FACULTY OF ARTS & SOCIAL SCIENCES	
1.	Psychology
2.	Urdu

FACULTY OF ISLAMIC STUDIES	
1.	Quran & Sunnah

FACULTY OF MANAGEMENT & ADMINISTRATIVE SCIENCES	
1.	Public Administration
2.	Business Administration

FACULTY OF PHARMACY & PHARMACEUTICAL SCIENCES	
1.	Pharmaceutics

FACULTY OF SCIENCE	
1.	Biochemistry
2.	Health, Physical Education & Sports Sciences (Physical Therapy)
3.	Mathematics
4.	Microbiology
5.	Physiology

INSTITUTES / CENTRES	
1.	Dr. A. Q. Khan Institute of Biotechnology & Genetic Engineering (Biotechnology)
2.	Dr. Panjwani Centre for Molecular Medicine & Drug Research (Molecular Medicine)
3.	HEJ Research Institute of Chemistry (Chemistry)
4.	Dr. M. Ajmal Khan Institute of Sustainable Halophyte Utilization (Botany)
5.	Institute of Space Science & Technology

UNIVERSITY OF KARACHI

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Post-Doctoral Fellowship considered to be an excellence and growth in careers. This is a facilitative step in the transition of research students in to an independent scholar. The fellowship with its numerous academic and research activities will further add to their professional development.

Post-Doctoral Fellow at the University of Karachi will be engaged in different departments and Institutes for the research / teaching and other academic activities in **Post-Doctoral Training**. **Post-Doctoral Fellow** is appointed for definite and specific terms. The University of Karachi has a set of guidelines for **Post-Doctoral Fellow**.

Eligibility and Selection Criteria for Post-Doctoral Fellowship:

- The candidate must have a PhD degree holder.
- The candidates can apply for the **Post-Doctoral Fellowship** program **after** the award of PhD degree.
- Candidate must have a 01 (one) HEC recognized publications.
- Candidate must have at least two (2) conference presentations in the National and International Conferences after PhD.
- Research proposal must be submitted by the Post-Doctoral Fellowship applicant with the consent of a regular faculty member of the concerned Department and Institute of University of Karachi as a Mentor.
- The Research proposal submitted by the applicant must not be mere extension of the PhD work. Preference should be given over the Original, Significantly Contributing, Novel, and with significant implications of the proposed proposal. The expertise in research brought in by the applicant will be an added factor in the selection process.
- The age limit for **Post-Doctoral Fellowship** shall be open for all age candidates.
- Post-Doctoral Fellowship candidate can bring funding from an external granting agency to the department. (Sponsored).

Post-Doctoral Fellowship Tenure:

- The tenure of the Post-Doctoral Fellowship is for a period of 09 months.

Post-Doctoral Fellowship Review:

The **Post-Doctoral Fellowship** review will be conducted biannually. Review will be based on quantitative and qualitative outcomes, based on the Performance, Publications and other work assigned by the **Post-Doctoral Mentor**.

Post-Doctoral Fellowship Monitoring Committee:

- All ASRB Members will be the part of **Post-Doctoral Fellowship Monitoring Committee**, and will evaluate the progress of Post-Doctoral Fellows Performance.
- The **Post-Doctoral Fellow** need to submit a progress report to **Post-Doctoral Fellowship Monitoring Committee** biannually about the research and other work assigned supported by reprints or relevant evidences or manuscripts of the paper published or accepted for publication for this purpose, duly endorsed by the **Post-Doctoral Mentor**.
- Extension of **Post-Doctoral Fellowship** will be facilitated on Progress and Performance of the work assigned. Further a justified rationale required by the **Post-Doctoral Mentor**.
- The **Post-Doctoral Fellowship** may be terminated at any time by the University if the progress and performance of the **Post-Doctoral Fellow** is unsatisfactory with a prior notice.
- All **Post-Doctoral Fellow s** are subject to termination with prior notice in cases where ethical or compliance criterions have been violated.

Engagements in Post-Doctoral Fellowship:

- **Post-Doctoral Fellow** and their **Mentor** must identify significant research topics and tasks for academic development and meet on regular basis (at least 2 meeting per month) to evaluate the progress.
- **Post-Doctoral Mentors** are encouraged to welcome **Post-Doctoral Fellow** who will be able to contribute to their research and research Projects and Groups.
- **Post-Doctoral Fellow** needs to facilitate their contribution to their field of interest through research, publications, research workshops and conference presentations. Further they can teach and supervise the small scale research of junior and undergraduate students.
- Teaching load equivalent to 6 Credits per week can be assigned to the **Post-Doctoral Fellow** independently, or it can be in shared course/s only with the **Post-Doctoral Mentor**, along with the other related academic and research activities.
- The **Post-Doctoral Fellow** is expected to assist the **Post-Doctoral Mentor** in writing the Grant Proposal and other external project proposals of National and International funding agency.
- Besides research work, **Post-Doctoral Fellow** will also be encouraged to be a part of funded Project with the **Post-Doctoral Mentor** as a co-investigator.

- **Post-Doctoral Fellow** must have one HJRS publications per year as the first or corresponding author with the **Post-Doctoral Mentor** along with *University of Karachi* recognition, must be accepted or published.

Expectations during the Post-Doctoral Fellowship:

- Responsible engagement of assigned tasks.
- Compliance for ethical standards.
- Compliance with Safe and cautious laboratory practices.
- Active participation in work assigned.

Other Relevant Rules:

- All **Post-Doctoral Fellows** will be eligible for **25 leaves** during the nine (9) months duration.
- Woman **Post-Doctoral Fellow** is eligible for maternity leave. The **Post-Doctoral Fellowship** duration, need to be completed after re-joining from maternity leave. The said leave will be sanctioned after the verification of University of Karachi, Lady Medical Officer.
- Woman **Post-Doctoral Fellow** is eligible for Iddat leave.

Post-Doctoral Fellowship Evaluation:

- At the end of the tenure of **Post-Doctoral Fellowship**, Written evaluations from the **Post-Doctoral Mentor** need to be submitted for the award of **Post-Doctoral Fellowship**.

Grievance Handling:

- **Post-Doctoral Fellow** has access to the University of Karachi, grievance policy.

Constitution of Scrutiny Committees:

Departmental/ Institute's Scrutiny Committee

- Convener: Chairperson/Director, (of Professor Cadre).
- Members: Two Senior Most Professors.
(Constituted a composition of three senior most Professors, lacking of composition can be filled by nominating ASRB members).

Required Eligibility for Post-Doctoral Mentor:

- **Post-Doctoral Mentor** will be an experienced Professor/Associate Professor who facilitates guidance, mentorship, and supervision to a **Post-Doctoral fellow**.

- **Post-Doctoral Mentor** will be a permanent or tenure-track position Professor/Associate Professor at University of Karachi.
- **Post-Doctoral Mentor** will have an extensive research experience, expertise in the field, and a track record of scholarly publications and shows a continuous progress.
- **Post-Doctoral Mentor** should be PhD with at-least ten (10) years of post-PhD experience in Academics and Research.
- **Post-Doctoral Mentor** should have proven record of Supervision of 04 MPhil and 08 PhD theses as Sole Supervisor or 12 PhD theses supervision and 25 HEC recognized publications in the relevant discipline.
- **Post-Doctoral Mentor** should ascertain the availability of laboratory, Equipment's and other relevant facilities if required. There will be no additional funding for the same.
- **Post-Doctoral Mentor** can take **02 Post-Doctoral Fellow** at a time.

PS: The eligibility and qualifications for Post-Doctoral Mentor may vary depending on the Department and program requirements and can be decided by ASRB.

Number of Post-Doctoral Fellows:

- The department/Institute will not have more than **04 Post-Doctoral Fellows** excluding the **02 Sponsored Post-Doctoral Fellows**.

Award of Post-Doctoral Fellowship:

- A Certificate or a Letter for the **Post-Doctoral Fellowship** can be facilitated, with the signature of **Post-Doctoral Mentor** and **Chairman ASRB**, need to be released by Registrar.

Post-Doctoral Fellowship Program

University of Karachi

Admission Procedure Post-Doctoral Fellowship

All candidates will be required to submit the following documents along with the Application Form:

- i. Consolidated transcript and PhD Degree.
- ii. Computerized National Identity Card.
- iii. Two (2) recent photograph
- iv. Submission of one (1) HEC recognized publications.
- v. Evidence of at least two (2) conference presentations in the National and International Conferences after PhD.
- vi. Research proposal must be submitted by the Post-Doctoral Fellowship applicant with the letter of consent of a regular faculty member (please see the mentor eligibility) of the concerned Department and Institute of University of Karachi as a Mentor.

Note: The age limit for Post-Doctoral Fellowship shall be open for all age candidates.

Post-Doctoral Fellowship Program

University of Karachi

FEE STRUCTURE

Extract from meeting of **Advanced Studies & Research Board (Any other item)**
(06) dated 24-02-2025

The following fee structure for postdoctoral admission in the respective faculties is approved.

Faculty of Arts & Social Sciences, Islamic Studies, Management & Administrative Sciences, Science, Pharmacy & Pharmaceutical Sciences

S.No.	Fee Category	Arts & Social Sciences, Islamic Studies	Science, Pharmacy & Pharmaceutical Sciences, Management & Administrative Sciences
01	Admission Processing Fee	Rs.10,000	Rs.10,000
02	Admission Fee	Rs.30,000	Rs.30,000
03	Tuition Fee	Rs.100,000	Rs.120,000
04	Departmental Charges	Rs.50,000	Rs.80,000
05	Mentor Fee	Rs.80,000	Rs.80,000

Foreign Students:

- Students can pay fees under categories 3, 4, and 5 in two installments
- Fee under categories 1 and 2 will be allocated to the Postgraduate Admission Office.
- The tuition fee (category 3) will be deposited into the university's main account.

Post-Doctoral Fellowship Program

University of Karachi

SCHEDULE

1.	Post-Doctoral Fellowship Announcement	April 05, 2026
2.	Post-Doctoral Fellowship Applications (Application Forms can be collected in person from the Postgraduate Admission Office, UOK)	April 06, 2026 To April 10, 2026
3.	Submission of Post-Doctoral Fellowship Application Forms (Application Forms should be submitted to the relevant Department along with required Documents)	April 13, 2026 To April 16, 2026
4.	Eligibility Review Process by the Concerned Department/Centre/Institute	April 17, 2026 To April 21, 2026
5.	List of Successful Candidates for Post-Doctoral Fellowship Program will be displayed on KU website	April 23, 2026
6.	Issuance and Submission of Post-Doctoral Fellowship Admission Forms along with Fee Voucher (Voucher duly endorsed by Postgraduate Admission Office) with all documents to the Postgraduate Admission Office, New Administration Building, Ground Floor.	April 24, 2026 To April 28, 2026

Post-Doctoral Fellowship Program

University of Karachi

ACADEMIC CALENDAR

Commencement of Program	May 01, 2026 to January 30, 2027	Nine (9) Months (Duration)
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